

THE GEORGIA HOMEOWNER'S SIDING GUIDE

Everything you need to know before replacing your siding — from a contractor who has done it 1,500+ times across Cobb, Cherokee and Fulton counties.

1,500+

Projects completed
in North Atlanta

15+

Years serving
Georgia homeowners

\$15K–30K

Typical James
Hardie project value

50 yrs

Expected siding lifespan
when done right

YOUR SIDING INVESTMENT

Replacing siding is one of the three largest exterior decisions a Georgia homeowner makes. Get it right and you have 50 years of protection. Get it wrong and you are looking at five-figure repairs.

\$15K–\$30K

Average Hardie install in
North Atlanta 2026

80%

ROI at resale —
highest exterior renovation

50+ yrs

Lifespan of proper fiber
cement installation

★ ELITE PREFERRED

James Hardie Certified
Top 2% Nationwide

WHY THIS GUIDE EXISTS

After 1,500+ siding projects across Cobb, Cherokee, and Fulton counties, we have seen the same expensive mistakes made by well-meaning homeowners who simply did not know what to ask or what to watch for.

This guide was written to level the playing field. The information here will help you evaluate any contractor — including us — so you can make the most informed decision on a \$15,000 to \$30,000 investment.

GEORGIA CLIMATE FACTOR

Georgia's HardieZone HZ10 climate — characterized by 50+ inches of annual rain, 90°F+ summers, active hail seasons, and the highest termite risk in the nation — makes siding selection and installation quality more critical here than in almost any other state. The wrong material or a bad install costs you far more in Georgia than it would in Colorado or Oregon.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- 01 Read it before you collect any quotes.
- 02 Bring it to every estimate appointment.
- 03 Use the checklist on page 6 to evaluate contractors.
- 04 Email any quote you receive for a free sanity check.

"This guide was written to help you make the right call — regardless of which contractor you ultimately choose."

— Siding Depot Team

WHICH SIDING IS RIGHT FOR GEORGIA?

CRITERIA	JAMES HARDIE (Recommended)	VINYL	ENGINEERED WOOD	NATURAL WOOD
	★ RECOMMENDED			
Georgia Climate Rating	★★★★★	★★★★■	★★★★■	★★■■■■
Expected Lifespan	50+ years	20–30 yrs	25–30 yrs	10–20 yrs
Maintenance Level	Very Low	Low	Moderate	High
Fire Resistance	Excellent	Poor	Good	Poor
Termite Resistance	Immune	Immune	Treated	Vulnerable
Hail Resistance	Excellent	Fair	Good	Fair
Product Warranty	30 years	25 years	5–10 years	None
ROI at Resale	~80%	~60%	~65%	~50%
Georgia HOA Compatibility	Universal	Varies	Good	Good

KEY TAKEAWAY
James Hardie HZ10 is the only siding system engineered specifically for Georgia's climate — heat, humidity, and storm season combined. It's not the cheapest option, but it's the right one.

Sources: James Hardie Corp, 2026 Remodeling Cost vs. Value Report, NAHB Georgia Chapter

5 MISTAKES GEORGIA HOMEOWNERS CANNOT AFFORD TO MAKE

Based on 1,500+ projects across Cobb, Cherokee and Fulton counties.

01

Choosing the Lowest Bid

On a \$25,000 project the gap between bids in Atlanta runs \$8,000–\$12,000. The lowest bid almost always means subcontracted day crews, builder-grade materials, or a missing line item that becomes a \$4,000 change order on day three. Compare the two middle bids line by line — not just the totals.

MISTAKE

02

Hiring Without James Hardie Certification

Only 2% of U.S. contractors earn Elite Preferred status. Without it, the 30-year transferable warranty is void — even with genuine Hardie product. A wrong flashing detail on a Georgia storm means warranty denied and an \$8,000+ repair out of your pocket. Always ask for the Hardie ID number.

MISTAKE

03

Skipping the Rotten-Wood Inspection

On 90% of Georgia homes over 15 years old, we find rotten OSB sheathing or rim boards behind existing siding. If your contract doesn't include a per-linear-foot price for wood replacement before work starts, a \$22,000 job can become \$30,000 mid-project — with your walls exposed.

MISTAKE

04

Installing Over Existing Siding

Some contractors skip the tear-off to save on labor and dump fees. This traps moisture between layers, hides existing damage, adds unplanned weight to framing, and voids the James Hardie warranty completely. Proper installation requires full tear-off, inspection, and continuous house wrap.

MISTAKE

05

Paying More Than 30% Upfront

Georgia standard: 25–30% to lock schedule and order materials. 40% at substantial completion. 30% at final walk-through. Any contractor demanding 50–100% upfront is likely using your deposit to finish someone else's job. This is the #1 cause of abandoned projects in our market.

MISTAKE

WHAT A PROPER INSTALLATION

LOOK

01

FREE ESTIMATE

(678) 400-2012 or sidingdepot.com

Itemized quote — every line explained. Ask about rot replacement pricing upfront. No pressure, no obligation. Response within 24 hours.

:

02

CONTRACT & SCHEDULE

Fixed price in writing · Permit pulled

25–30% deposit. Start date confirmed. Permit submitted to county. No work begins until all paperwork is in order.

:

03

FULL TEAR-OFF

All existing siding removed

Complete removal of old siding. Sheathing inspected. Any rotten wood documented, photographed, and priced before replacement begins.

:

04

HOUSE WRAP

Continuous water-resistive barrier

Proper house wrap installed over entire wall assembly. Critical step for warranty compliance — skipping this voids the Hardie warranty.

:

05

HARDIE INSTALLATION

HZ10-certified install

Correct fastening schedule, clearances from grade, flashing details at windows and doors, caulk joints. Every specification by the book.

:

06

FINAL WALK-THROUGH

You inspect everything · Warranty docs

You walk the job with the crew present. Every concern addressed on the spot. Certificate of completion and warranty documents delivered.

THE SIDING DEPOT COMMITMENT

Every Siding Depot project follows these 6 steps exactly. In-house crews only. No subcontractors. No shortcuts. Fixed price confirmed in writing before work begins. If we find rotten wood, we document and price it before we touch it.

8 QUESTIONS EVERY HOMEOWNER MUST ASK

1

Are you James Hardie Elite Preferred?

Ask for the ID number. Verify at jameshardie.com/contractor-locator. No ID = walk away.

☐

2

Are you licensed in Georgia with GL + workers' comp?

Ask for the certificate of insurance. Call the carrier to verify it's current before signing.

☐

3

Do you use W-2 employees or subcontractors?

In-house crews have accountability. Subcontracted day crews have none. Know who's on your property.

☐

4

What is your per-linear-foot price for rotten wood?

If they hesitate or say "we'll figure it out," that's a \$5,000+ risk. Get a number before signing.

☐

5

Will you do a full tear-off and install house wrap?

Any answer other than a clear "yes" disqualifies them. No tear-off = no valid Hardie warranty.

☐

6

What does your payment schedule look like?

Milestone-based only. No more than 30% upfront. If they ask for 50%+, look elsewhere.

☐

7

What workmanship warranty do you provide in writing?

Product warranty ≠ labor warranty. You need both in writing. Ask specifically how long for labor.

☐

8

Can I see 3 recent projects within 10 miles?

Driving 30 minutes to see real work is worth it. If they can't provide local references, that's your answer.

☐**★ FREE QUOTE REVIEW OFFER**

Email any quote you've received to office@sidingdepot.com with subject "Quote Review" and we'll flag anything unusual — free, no obligation, no sales call. We do this because it's the right thing to do.

WHY GEORGIA'S CLIMATE DEMANDS THE RIGHT SIDING

HARDIEZONE HZ10 — ENGINEERED FOR GEORGIA

James Hardie doesn't sell one product for the whole country. The HZ10 system is specifically formulated for hot, humid climates — Georgia, Florida, the Gulf Coast. This means the chemistry of the fiber cement, the factory paint bake, and the installation specifications are all calibrated for our conditions. A contractor certified for HZ10 installation is not interchangeable with one trained in northern climates.

50+ INCHES OF RAIN PER YEAR

Georgia receives more annual rainfall than Seattle — a fact that surprises most homeowners. This sustained moisture exposure is the primary cause of rot, mold, and siding failure on homes in Cobb, Cherokee, and Fulton counties. Fiber cement is impervious to moisture absorption. Wood, and to a lesser extent vinyl, are not.

HAIL SEASON: MARCH THROUGH JUNE

North Atlanta sits in a secondary hail corridor. Quarter-sized hail — common across Cherokee County in spring — can bruise asphalt shingles and crack vinyl siding in a single storm. Fiber cement absorbs impact without cracking. Check your homeowner's insurance policy: most cover hail damage, but you must file within 12 months of the event.

TERMITE RISK — HIGHEST IN THE NATION

Georgia ranks in the highest termite risk zone nationally. Wood siding provides a direct pathway. Fiber cement eliminates termite risk to the siding material entirely. This matters most on homes with crawl spaces — a common construction style in Cherokee County.

 **50+**

inches of rain
annually in Georgia

 **95°F+**

summer peaks that
warp vinyl siding

 **1,553**

lightning strikes per
100 sq mi per year

 **#1 Risk**

termite zone
nationwide

 **220+**

sunny days annually
— UV demands quality paint

BOTTOM LINE FOR NORTH ATLANTA HOMEOWNERS

Georgia's climate is among the most demanding in the country for exterior building materials. James Hardie HZ10, properly installed, is the only product we've seen perform flawlessly for 15+ years here.

★ JAMES HARDIE ELITE PREFERRED · TOP 2% NATIONWIDE

READY FOR AN HONEST ESTIMATE?

Free. Itemized. No pressure. We respond within 24 hours.

- ✓ Licensed & Insured in Georgia
- ✓ In-house crews — no subcontractors
- ✓ Fixed price — no surprise change orders

GET YOUR FREE ESTIMATE

(678) 400-2012

office@sidingdepot.com

sidingdepot.com/contact

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Mon–Fri 8AM–6PM · Sat 9AM–3PM

Marietta · Alpharetta · Milton · Canton · Woodstock · Roswell
Kennesaw · Johns Creek · Sandy Springs · Acworth

James Hardie

Elite Preferred

GAF Factory

Certified

BBB

A+ Rated

Licensed &

Insured GA